



The Indian market has always been rife with competition in the budget smartphone category. Smartphone OEMs across the board are making a conscious effort to provide users with an array of options that don't break the bank, of course, but also don't skimp out on performance. The sub-₹20,000 price segment has historically been the most favoured segment in India, and the trend continued in 2023. This time around, we got to experience a lot more premium-esque features in this segment including bright AMOLED displays, high refresh rate, the addition of ultrawide cameras, fast charging, under-screen displays, and much more. The budget smartphone segment was, by far, our most competitive smartphone category with 12 fierce entrants vying for the trophy. But, in the end, only one can be crowned the winner...

Winner: iQOO Z7 5G

When it comes to raw power, the iQOO Z7 5G runs circles around its competition. The phone houses the powerful MediaTek Dimensity 920 SoC that runs on a 6 nm process with a maximum clock speed of 2.5 GHz. The result is almost unbridled, class-leading performance at a very affordable price. The iQOO Z7 5G consistently outperformed its challengers in CPU, GPU and even storage benchmarks. All while throttling very little. The gaming performance is extremely smooth and fluid as well. If you're a mobile gamer looking for an affordable yet fast smartphone, the

Budget Phone

Light on your pocket, not on performance



iQOO Z7 5G
Price: ₹18,999

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



Motorola Moto G54 5G
Price: ₹18,999

iQOO Z7 5G is your best bet in 2023. Furthermore, the battery life is pretty decent and the charging speeds are one of the fastest in the segment. The 90 Hz AMOLED display also looks great with HDR10+ support and a high rated peak brightness of 1,300 nits. The only downside here is the mediocre cameras. For everything else performance-related, the iQOO Z7 is the undisputed winner, which is why it takes the trophy for the Best Performing Budget Phone of 2023.

Runner-up: Samsung Galaxy M34 5G

While the iQOO Z7 5G reigned supreme in terms of performance under ₹20,000, one phone was only a smidge behind. That was the Samsung Galaxy M34 5G. The Galaxy M34 gave the iQOO Z7 tough competition in all synthetic benchmarks and real-world performance. Sadly, it did lose out significant points in the storage benchmarks where it scored about half of what the iQOO Z7 was capable of. However, there are some areas where the Samsung Galaxy M34 actually takes the win over the iQOO Z7 – namely the camera quality and battery life. The point difference in raw performance was enough for the iQOO Z7 5G to pull ahead.



Samsung Galaxy M34 5G
Price: ₹16,999

Best Buy: Motorola Moto G54

The Motorola Moto G54 5G does a lot of things well. It has decently speedy performance, courtesy the MediaTek Dimensity 7020 chipset. The phone's battery is one of the longest lasting in the segment. In fact, with a single charge to 100 percent, the phone lasted us more than two days. To top it off, 33 W fast charging means that it is also one of the fastest charging phones in the segment. The cameras are also excellent for the price, with good detail retention and HDR performance in well-lit conditions. Overall, the Motorola Moto G54 provides great value for your hard-earned money. It is a solid mix of performance and features - a deserving winner of our Best Buy Award.

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